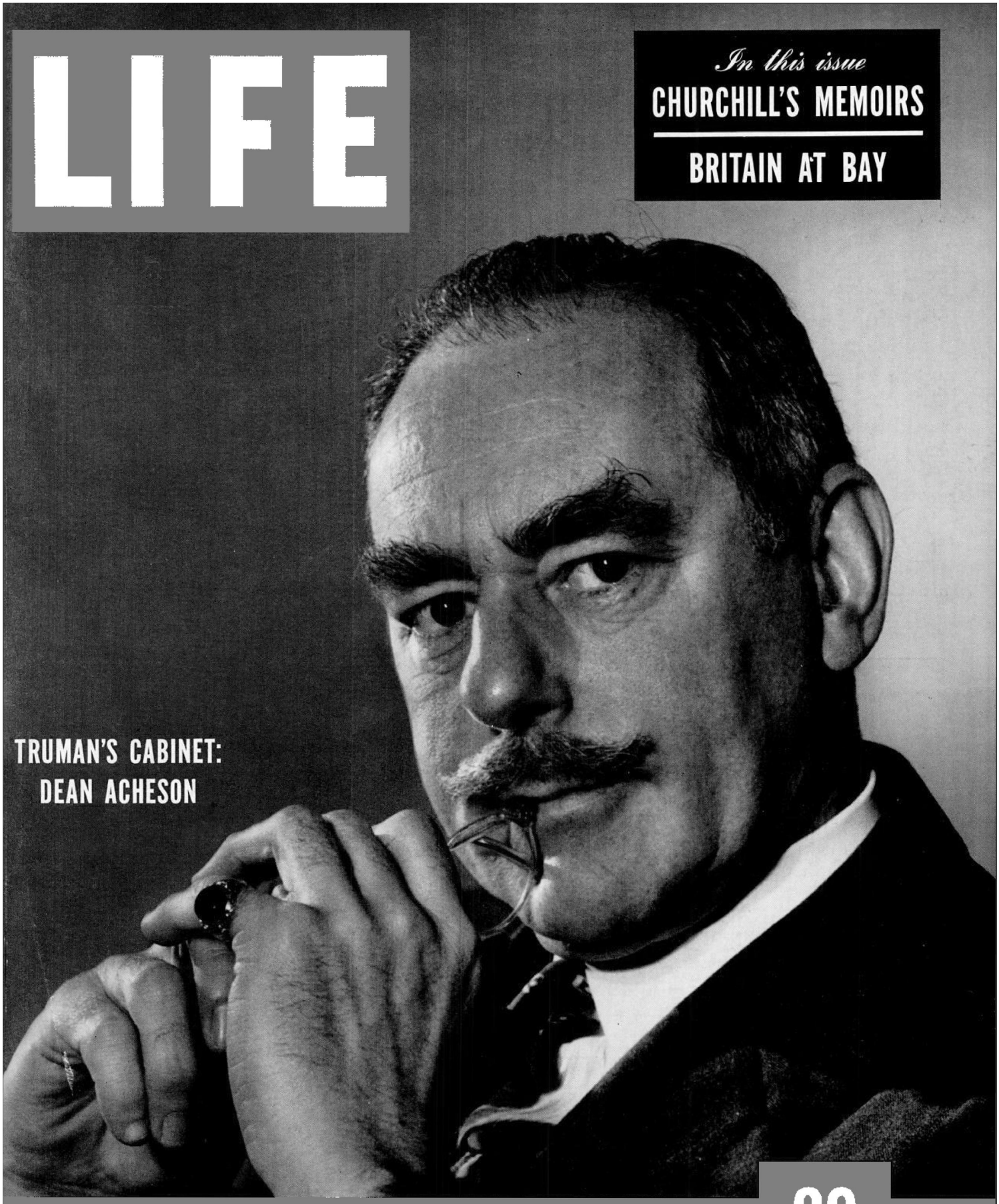


LIFE

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PEOPLE

ECA'S LAPHAM PAYS A CALL ON FORMOSA'S TRIBAL PRINCESSES

The white-haired gentleman sitting on the bamboo fence is San Francisco's former mayor, Roger Lapham, who despite failure of American policy in China has had great personal success as the chief of ECA's China mission. The brown-skinned young women beside him are "princesses" of a tribe of aborigines on the Chinese island of Formosa, which is of high strategic importance for the defense of Japan. Lapham visited Formosa in preparation for a trip to Washington, where he is expected this week to propose new decisions on ECA's China program—now bogged down in civil war and Red victory. Lapham looked into a fertilizer factory which ECA experts would like to expand and grinned through several Chinese banquets, before driving to Sun-Moon Lake to inspect a needy hydroelectric power plant and see the island's aborigines. Just before this picture was taken the playful princesses had removed Lapham's necktie and wrapped it around his head, native fashion. They watched calmly while he unbuttoned his collar, but afterward, when the outsized American danced a jig, the princesses showed all their gold teeth laughing. It seemed possible that Lapham's hour among the natives would live in Oriental legend with the famous 1944 flight of Ambassador Patrick Hurley to the Chinese Communist capital, Yenan, where he landed whooping like a Choctaw Indian.

